

# MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

## Executive Leadership Bios

Partner & Managing Director Profiles

**CONFIDENTIAL**

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Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

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## 1. Sarah Chen, CPA, CISA

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### Lead Partner, Financial Services Practice

**Years of Experience:** 27 years

**Office:** New York, NY

**Direct Line:** +1 (212) 555-0142

**Email:** s.chen@meridian-llp.com

### *Professional Summary*

Sarah Chen is the Lead Partner for Meridian & Associates' Financial Services Practice, overseeing a portfolio of engagements spanning commercial banking, capital markets, insurance, and wealth management. With 27 years of experience advising Fortune 500 financial institutions, Sarah has led transformative programs totaling over \$2.8 billion in aggregate project value. She is recognized as a leading authority on regulatory compliance, core banking modernization, and enterprise risk management.

Sarah joined Meridian in 2004 after nine years at a competing Big Four firm, where she served as a Senior Manager in the banking and capital markets audit practice. Since her promotion to Partner in 2010, she has grown the Financial Services Practice revenue from \$85 million to over \$340 million annually, establishing Meridian as a top-tier advisor to US and European banks.

### *Education*

- MBA, Finance & Strategy, The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania (2001)
- BS, Accounting, magna cum laude, University of Michigan (1999)

### *Certifications & Memberships*

- Certified Public Accountant (CPA), State of New York
- Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA)
- Fellow, Institute of Chartered Accountants
- Board Member, Financial Services Roundtable
- Advisory Board, Columbia Business School Center for Financial Innovation

### *Industry Specializations*

- Core banking transformation and cloud migration
- Regulatory compliance (Basel III/IV, Dodd-Frank, SOX 404)
- Enterprise risk management and operational resilience
- Digital payments and open banking architecture
- Post-merger integration for financial institutions

### *Notable Engagements (Blinded)*

- **Top-10 US Retail Bank:** Led 18-month core banking modernization program (85-person team). Migrated legacy mainframe to cloud-native architecture, achieving 40% reduction in transaction processing time and \$32M annual infrastructure savings.

- **Global Investment Bank:** Directed \$45M regulatory remediation program across three jurisdictions following consent order. Achieved full regulatory compliance within 14 months, ahead of schedule.
- **Major Insurance Carrier:** Oversaw enterprise data governance initiative covering 2.3 petabytes of customer data across 14 legacy platforms. Resulted in 60% improvement in data quality scores.

#### ***Publications & Thought Leadership***

- "The Future of Core Banking: Cloud-Native Architectures for the Next Decade" - Harvard Business Review (2025)
- "Navigating Regulatory Change in a Post-Basel IV World" - Journal of Financial Regulation (2024)
- Keynote Speaker, Sibos Annual Conference (2024, 2025)
- Panelist, World Economic Forum, Davos - Financial Services Track (2025)

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## **2. Michael Torres, CPA, PMP**

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### **Lead Partner, Healthcare & Life Sciences Practice**

**Years of Experience:** 24 years

**Office:** Chicago, IL

**Direct Line:** +1 (312) 555-0287

**Email:** m.torres@meridian-llp.com

#### ***Professional Summary***

Michael Torres leads Meridian's Healthcare & Life Sciences Practice, serving health systems, pharmaceutical companies, medical device manufacturers, and health insurance plans. Over his 24-year career, Michael has managed more than 60 large-scale engagements in the healthcare sector, including post-merger integrations, EHR implementations, revenue cycle transformations, and value-based care program designs. He brings a rare combination of deep clinical operations understanding and financial acumen that enables him to bridge the gap between C-suite strategy and frontline clinical delivery.

Before joining Meridian in 2008, Michael spent six years at a global management consulting firm and five years in hospital administration at a major academic medical center. His operational background gives him a practitioner's perspective that clients consistently cite as a differentiator. Under his leadership, the Healthcare Practice has achieved a 94% client retention rate and has been named a top-tier healthcare advisory practice by Modern Healthcare for four consecutive years.

#### ***Education***

- MBA, Healthcare Management, Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University (2006)
- MHA, Master of Health Administration, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (2002)
- BS, Biology, Georgetown University (2000)

#### ***Certifications & Memberships***

- Certified Public Accountant (CPA), State of Illinois
- Project Management Professional (PMP)
- Fellow, American College of Healthcare Executives (FACHE)
- Board of Directors, American Hospital Association - Council on Finance
- Advisory Council Member, HIMSS (Healthcare Information and Management Systems Society)

#### ***Industry Specializations***

- Post-merger integration for health systems
- Electronic Health Record (EHR) implementation and optimization (Epic, Cerner, MEDITECH)
- Revenue cycle management and claims denial reduction
- Value-based care program design and population health analytics
- Healthcare regulatory compliance (HIPAA, Stark Law, Anti-Kickback)

#### ***Notable Engagements (Blinded)***

- **12-Hospital Regional System:** Led 24-month post-merger integration program (120+ person team). Unified Epic EHR, harmonized clinical workflows, and established shared services center. Realized \$52M in synergies, exceeding \$45M target.
- **Top-5 Health Insurance Plan:** Directed claims processing transformation reducing average adjudication time from 14 days to 3.2 days. Improved clean claims rate from 76% to 94%, generating \$28M in annual savings.
- **Academic Medical Center:** Oversaw Epic Beaker and Radiant implementation across 3 hospitals and 120 ambulatory sites. Completed on-time and 8% under budget.

#### ***Publications & Thought Leadership***

- "Realizing Synergies in Health System Mergers: A Framework for Clinical Integration" - New England Journal of Medicine Catalyst (2025)
- "The Revenue Cycle of the Future: AI-Enabled Claims Management" - Healthcare Financial Management Association (2024)
- Keynote Speaker, HIMSS Global Health Conference (2024, 2025)

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### **3. Dr. Priya Ramanathan, CISSP, TOGAF**

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#### **Lead Partner, Technology & Digital Advisory Practice**

**Years of Experience:** 22 years

**Office:** San Francisco, CA

**Direct Line:** +1 (415) 555-0193

**Email:** p.ramanathan@meridian-llp.com

#### ***Professional Summary***

Dr. Priya Ramanathan leads Meridian's Technology & Digital Advisory Practice, one of the firm's fastest-growing service lines with \$280 million in annual revenue and a compound annual growth rate of 22% over the past four years. Priya specializes in enterprise architecture, cloud transformation, cybersecurity strategy, and AI/ML implementation at scale. Her technical depth, combined with her ability to translate complex technology concepts into board-level strategic narratives, has made her a trusted advisor to CTOs and CIOs across the Fortune 500.

Priya holds a Ph.D. in Computer Science from Stanford University with a focus on distributed systems and machine learning. Prior to joining Meridian in 2011, she spent eight years at a leading technology consulting firm and two years as VP of Engineering at a Series C fintech startup. She holds over a dozen patents in distributed computing and has published extensively in peer-reviewed journals on topics ranging from zero-trust architecture to responsible AI governance.

#### ***Education***

- Ph.D., Computer Science (Distributed Systems & Machine Learning), Stanford University (2006)
- MS, Computer Science, Stanford University (2003)
- BTech, Computer Science & Engineering, Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (2001)

#### ***Certifications & Memberships***

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- TOGAF 9 Certified Enterprise Architect
- AWS Solutions Architect - Professional
- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect
- Board of Advisors, MIT Sloan Center for Information Systems Research (CISR)
- Member, National Academy of Engineering (elected 2024)

#### ***Industry Specializations***

- Enterprise cloud transformation and multi-cloud architecture
- Cybersecurity strategy, zero-trust architecture, and incident response
- Artificial intelligence and machine learning at enterprise scale
- Digital product development and platform engineering
- Technology due diligence for M&A transactions

#### ***Notable Engagements (Blinded)***

- **Large US State Government Agency:** Led 30-month enterprise cloud migration program (90-person team). Migrated 1,800 applications to Azure Government, achieving FedRAMP High authorization and 35% reduction in IT operating costs.
- **Global Retail Conglomerate:** Directed AI/ML center of excellence buildout, deploying 23 production ML models across demand forecasting, pricing optimization, and customer segmentation. Generated \$140M in incremental revenue within 18 months.
- **Fortune 100 Technology Company:** Oversaw zero-trust security architecture implementation across 180,000 endpoints in 42 countries. Reduced mean time to detect (MTTD) from 72 hours to 4 hours.

#### ***Publications & Thought Leadership***

- "Zero Trust at Scale: Lessons from 50 Enterprise Implementations" - IEEE Security & Privacy (2025)
- "Responsible AI Governance: A Framework for the Enterprise" - MIT Sloan Management Review (2024)
- 12 patents in distributed computing and machine learning systems
- Keynote Speaker, AWS re:Invent (2024), RSA Conference (2025)

## ~~4. James O'Sullivan, CPA, Six Sigma Black Belt~~

### **Lead Partner, Manufacturing & Industrial Practice**

**Years of Experience:** 26 years

**Office:** Chicago, IL

**Direct Line:** +1 (312) 555-0356

**Email:** j.osullivan@meridian-llp.com

#### ***Professional Summary***

James O'Sullivan leads Meridian's Manufacturing & Industrial Practice, serving clients across discrete manufacturing, process industries, aerospace & defense, and industrial distribution. With 26 years of experience, James has guided over 40 major engagements focused on supply chain transformation, operational excellence, ERP modernization, and sustainability strategy. His deep understanding of manufacturing operations, combined with his background in financial advisory, enables him to deliver programs that generate measurable financial returns while building long-term operational resilience.

Prior to his 18-year tenure at Meridian, James spent eight years at a leading industrial consulting firm and began his career as a cost accountant at a Fortune 100 automotive manufacturer. He is widely recognized in the industry for his work on digital supply chain enablement and has been named one of Supply Chain Management Review's 'Pros to Know' for three consecutive years. Under his leadership, the Manufacturing Practice has grown to \$195 million in annual revenue with a team of 420 professionals globally.

#### ***Education***

- MBA, Operations & Supply Chain Management, University of Chicago Booth School of Business (2004)
- BS, Accounting, University of Notre Dame (1998)

#### ***Certifications & Memberships***

- Certified Public Accountant (CPA), State of Illinois
- Six Sigma Black Belt (ASQ Certified)
- APICS Certified Supply Chain Professional (CSCP)
- Board Member, National Association of Manufacturers - Digital Transformation Council
- Advisory Board, Georgia Tech Supply Chain & Logistics Institute

#### ***Industry Specializations***

- Supply chain transformation, demand planning, and inventory optimization
- SAP S/4HANA and ERP modernization for manufacturing
- Operational excellence and lean manufacturing (Six Sigma, TPS)
- Sustainability and ESG strategy for industrial companies (Scope 1-3 emissions)
- Industry 4.0, IoT, and smart factory implementation

#### ***Notable Engagements (Blinded)***

- **Fortune 200 Diversified Manufacturer:** Led 16-month supply chain transformation program (65-person team).



Implemented SAP IBP, deployed control tower, and launched AI-driven demand sensing. Achieved 28% inventory reduction (\$106M freed working capital) and 95% OTIF delivery.

- **Global Aerospace OEM:** Directed SAP S/4HANA implementation across 22 manufacturing plants in 8 countries. Consolidated 6 legacy ERP instances into single global template. Delivered \$38M in annual process efficiency gains.
- **Mid-Market Industrial Distributor:** Oversaw operational turnaround engagement during Chapter 11 restructuring. Reduced operating costs by 24%, renegotiated \$120M in supplier contracts, and enabled successful emergence from bankruptcy within 9 months.

#### ***Publications & Thought Leadership***

- "The Digital Supply Chain: From Visibility to Autonomous Decision-Making" - Harvard Business Review (2025)
- "Scope 3 Emissions in Manufacturing: Measurement, Reduction, and Reporting" - MIT Sloan Management Review (2024)
- Keynote Speaker, Gartner Supply Chain Symposium (2024, 2025)